

动理学方程的高效特征线型渐近保持方法

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摘要: 动理学方程是描述微观粒子运动规律的重要数学模型, 其多尺度和高维度等特性为数值格式的设计带来显著挑战. 渐近保持格式是一类重要的多尺度计算框架, 旨在整个计算域内使用统一的数值求解器, 自动捕捉方程的渐近极限. 近年来, 我们以特征线回溯思想为基础, 发展了一类全尺度一致无条件稳定的渐近保持算法框架, 它具备无条件稳定、计算复杂度低、高度可并行和良好可扩展等优点, 特别适合高维跨尺度输运问题的长时间数值模拟, 将在国防工程、天体物理、半导体和生物化学等领域有广阔的应用前景.

关键词: 动理学方程; 并行计算; 特征线回溯法; 渐近保持格式

中图分类号: O241.8

文献标识码: A

0 引言

动理学方程是描述微观粒子运动规律的重要数学模型, 在辐射输运^[1]、等离子体物理^[2]、半导体^[3]和生物化学^[4]等领域具有广泛应用. 粒子在自由输运时不断发生碰撞, 其演化过程在统计意义下可由微分方程描述:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial t} + T(f) = C(f).$$

其中, $f = f(t, x, v)$ 为粒子分布函数, $t \geq 0$ 为时间变量, $x \in \mathbb{X}$ 为位置变量, $v \in \mathbb{V}$ 为速度变量, $\mathbb{X} \times \mathbb{V}$ 为相空间, T 为输运算子, C 为碰撞算子.

动理学方程具有双曲-抛物混合特性. 传统数值离散多采用直线型方法 (method of lines): 先离散相空间, 再离散时间. 时间离散常采用隐式方法、预估校正法或特征线法, 以缓解刚性项带来的时间步长约束. 相空间离散可分为确定性方法与随机性方法. 在确定性方法中, 矩方法(moment method)和离散速度法(discrete velocity method)均是先对速度变量 v 采用全局近似, 再对位置变量 x 采用分片近似. 矩方法^[5,6]通过对速度变量进行矩展开, 利用正则化思想构造矩封闭条件^[7-11], 将高维动理学模型约简成低维宏观模型. 然而, 宏观模型的输运结构更加复杂, 在输运占优问题中易出现强波动性^[12,13]. 离散速度法^[14]在有限个离散速度点上直接求解动理学方程, 可严格保持输运结构. 但是, 由于信息传播方

收稿日期: 2025-##-11-##21; 修回日期: 2025-##-00-00

基金项目: 国家重点研发计划重点专项项目 (2022YFA1004500)、国家自然科学基金项目 (12571443)、福建省自然科学基金 (2023J02003)

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向受限于预设速度集, 当速度点数不足时易出现射线效应^[15,16]. 随机性方法的代表为蒙特卡罗法^[17] (Monte-Carlo method). 该方法根据方程的积分形式将动理学方程等价表述为粒子随机运动过程, 利采用随机采样构造数值解, 具有无网格性与高度并行性, 但在强碰撞区域计算效率会显著下降.

动理学方程具有多尺度特征. 为分析其长时间演化行为, 可通过量纲分析引入无量纲参数 Knudsen 数 ε , 并考虑下列多尺度模型:

$$\varepsilon \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} + T(f) = \frac{\varepsilon}{\lambda(\varepsilon)} C(f).$$

当 $\lambda(\varepsilon) \sim \varepsilon$ 时, 输运效应与碰撞效应处于相同量级, 当 $t/\varepsilon \rightarrow +\infty$ 时, 方程收敛至稳态极限. 当 $\lambda(\varepsilon) \sim \varepsilon^2$ 时, 碰撞效应显著增强但仍不足以完全抹平输运效应, 方程呈现双曲-抛物混合特性: 当 $\varepsilon \gg 0$ 时, 方程是双曲占优的; 当 $\varepsilon \approx 0$ 时, 方程是抛物占优的; 当 $t \rightarrow +\infty$ 时, 方程仍然收敛至稳态极限. 为构造能够同时适用于不同区域的数值方法, 现有研究主要沿两个方向发展: 区域分解(domain decomposition)与渐近保持(asymptotic-preserving). 区域分解方法^[18-24]将计算域划分为不同的物理子区域, 在各区域分别采用适合的数值方法求解, 并通过界面条件实现整体匹配. 渐近保持方法^[25]旨在整个计算域内采用统一的数值方法, 在离散意义下自动捕捉方程的渐近极限. 典型的渐近保持格式有: 1) 松弛格式^[26,27]; 2) 宏微观分解^[28-34]; 3) 奇偶分解^[35,36]; 4) 罚函数法^[37,38]; 5) 指数积分法^[39-43]等等.

近年来, 我们以线性动理学方程为出发点, 围绕特征线回溯法开展了一系列研究, 发展了一类全尺度无条件稳定、高度可并行且易扩展的渐近保持算法, 并进行了相应的理论稳定性分析. 同时, 我们进一步将该算法推广应用于非线性辐射输运方程, 取得了良好的数值效果.

1 基于特征线回溯法的渐近保持格式

对于具有抛物极限的多尺度动理学模型, 其输运项和碰撞项在 $\varepsilon \approx 0$ 时均具有强刚性, 这为时间离散带来了显著的数值挑战. 一方面, 根据 CFL 条件, 显式格式受到非常严苛的时间步长约束 $\tau \sim \varepsilon h$, 其中 τ 为时间步长, h 为空间尺寸; 另一方面, 隐式格式虽然无条件稳定, 但在高维情形下需求解大规模强耦合线性系统, 计算成本极其高昂. 为平衡稳定性和计算成本, Peng 等^[32-34]构造了一类显隐格式, 通过隐式处理扩散相关项, 实现抛物占优区域($\varepsilon \ll h$)无条件稳定. 但是, 在过渡区域($\varepsilon \sim h$)仍然会受限于抛物型时间步长约束($\tau \sim h^2$)对跨区域问题而言仍存在明显局限. 注意到这一瓶颈的根源在于输运项的刚性, 我们发展了一类基于特征线回溯法的渐近保持格式^[44,45], 其具备如下优势:

- 1) 全尺度一致无条件稳定性且计算复杂度低. 与显式格式相比, 该方法在理论上不受 CFL 步长约束; 与隐式格式相比, 仅需求解少量小规模宏观线性系统, 计算代价显著降低; 与显隐格式相比, 在过渡区域仍可保持无条件稳定, 从而显著提升跨区域问题的计算效率;
- 2) 高度并行性. 在传统隐式迎风格式中, 由于目标时间层单元在位置变量上具有强耦合性, 导致算法关于位置变量的并行效率低下. 而特征线回溯法可完全解耦目标时间层单元, 使算法在整个相空间上具有近似线性的加速比;
- 3) 良好的可扩展性与兼容性. 该方法对具有刚性输运项的动理学模型均具有普适性. 此外, 我们已经将其应用至蒙特卡罗法^[46, 47]和矩方法^[48]框架, 显著提升了相应方法在长时间模拟时的稳定性和计算效率.

1.1 模型重构

下面我们以一维方程为例介绍基于特征线法的模型重构过程. 设 $E(v)$ 是全局平衡态函数, 满足归一化条件和对称性条件:

$$\int_{\mathbb{V}} E(v) dv = 1, \quad \int_{\mathbb{V}} v E(v) dv = 0. \quad (1)$$

设 $f_{eq}(t, x, v) = \rho(t, x) E(v)$, $\rho(t, x) = \int_{\mathbb{V}} f(t, x, v) dv$, 考虑一维线性输运方程:

$$\varepsilon \frac{\partial f}{\partial t}(t, x, v) + v \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(t, x, v) = \frac{\varepsilon \sigma}{\lambda(\varepsilon)} (f_{eq}(t, x, v) - f(t, x, v)). \quad (2)$$

设 $j(t, x) = \int_{\mathbb{V}} v f(t, x, v) dv$, 系统满足局部质量守恒律:

$$\varepsilon \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t}(t, x) + \frac{\partial j}{\partial x}(t, x) = 0. \quad (3)$$

设 $f_{\perp}(t, x, v) = f(t, x, v) - f_{eq}(t, x, v)$, 由 f_{eq} 的定义和 E 的归一化条件得

$$\int_{\mathbb{V}} f_{\perp}(t, x, v) dv = 0. \quad (4)$$

引入参数 τ , 由特征线法得

$$f(t, x, v) = e^{-\sigma \tau / \lambda} f(t - \tau, x - \frac{v}{\varepsilon} \tau, v) + \int_0^{\tau} \frac{\sigma}{\lambda} e^{-\sigma(\tau-s)/\lambda} f_{eq}(t - \tau + s, x - \frac{v}{\varepsilon}(\tau - s), v) ds. \quad (5)$$

引入参数 $\theta = \theta(\sigma, \lambda) \in [0, 1]$ 满足: 1) 当 $\sigma \rightarrow 0$ 时, $\theta \rightarrow 1$; 2) 当 $\lambda \sim \varepsilon$ 时, $\theta \approx 1$; 3)

当 $\lambda \sim \varepsilon^2$ 或 $\sigma \rightarrow +\infty$ 时, $\theta \approx 0$. 由(5)可将 $f_{\perp}(t, x, v)$ 分解为凸组合

$$f_{\perp}(t, x, v) = \theta f_{\perp, H}(t, x, v) + (1 - \theta) f_{\perp, P}(t, x, v). \quad (6)$$

一方面, $f_{\perp, H}(t, x, v)$ 用于捕捉自由输运极限和稳态极限, 写作

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$$f_{\perp,H}(t,x,v) = e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda}(f_{\perp} + f_{eq})(t-\tau, x - \frac{v}{\varepsilon}\tau, v) - e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda}f_{eq}(t,x,v) + r_H(t,x,v). \quad (7)$$

定义

$$\varphi_k(z) = \begin{cases} 1, & k=0; \\ \int_0^1 \frac{\omega^{k-1}}{(k-1)!} e^{\omega z} d\omega, & k \geq 1. \end{cases} \quad (8)$$

其满足

$$\varphi_k(0) = \frac{1}{k!}, \quad \forall k \geq 0, \quad (9)$$

且

$$\varphi_k(z) = \frac{e^z \varphi_{k-1}(0) - \varphi_{k-1}(z)}{z}, \quad \forall k \geq 1. \quad (10)$$

记 $\phi_k(z) = z^k \varphi_k(z)$, $D^k = \left(\frac{\lambda}{\sigma}\right)^k \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial t} + \frac{v}{\varepsilon} \frac{\partial}{\partial x}\right)^k$, 则残差项 $r_H(t,x,v)$ 可写作

$$r_H(t,x,v) = -e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda} \sum_{k \geq 1} \phi_{k+1}\left(-\frac{\sigma\tau}{\lambda}\right) D^k f_{eq}(t,x,v). \quad (11)$$

另一方面, $f_{\perp,p}(t,x,v)$ 由分部积分法得到, 用于捕捉抛物极限, 写作

$$f_{\perp,p}(t,x,v) = e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda} f_{\perp}(t-\tau, x - \frac{v}{\varepsilon}\tau, v) - \frac{\lambda}{\sigma} (1 - e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda}) \left(\frac{\partial f_{eq}}{\partial t} + \frac{v}{\varepsilon} \frac{\partial f_{eq}}{\partial x}\right)(t,x,v) - r_p(t,x,v), \quad (12)$$

其中, 残差项 $r_p(t,x,v)$ 可写作

$$r_p(t,x,v) = -\frac{\lambda}{\sigma} e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda} \sum_{k \geq 1} \phi_{k+1}\left(-\frac{\sigma\tau}{\lambda}\right) D^{k+1} f_{eq}(t,x,v). \quad (13)$$

将上述特征线解代入(3), 联立(2)可得

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial f}{\partial t}(t,x,v) + \frac{v}{\varepsilon} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(t,x,v) = \frac{\sigma}{\lambda} (f_{eq}(t,x,v) - f(t,x,v)), \\ \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t}(t,x) + \frac{1}{\varepsilon} e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda} \int_{\mathbb{V}} v \frac{\partial(f_{\perp} + \theta f_{eq})}{\partial x}(t-\tau, x - \frac{v}{\varepsilon}\tau, v) dv = \frac{\lambda}{\varepsilon^2 \sigma} (1-\theta)(1 - e^{-\sigma\tau/\lambda}) \Theta \frac{\partial^2 \rho}{\partial x^2}(t,x) + R(t,x). \end{cases} \quad (14)$$

其中, $\Theta = \int_{\mathbb{V}} v^2 E(v) dv$ 为扩散系数, $R(t,x)$ 为残差项, 写作

$$R(t,x) = \int_{\mathbb{V}} v(\theta r_H(t,x,v) - (1-\theta)r_p(t,x,v)) dv. \quad (15)$$

当 $\lambda(\varepsilon) = \varepsilon$ 时, 有 $\theta = 1$,

$$f(t,x,v) \xrightarrow{t/\varepsilon \rightarrow +\infty} f^{\infty}(v) = \rho^{\infty}(x) E(v). \quad (16)$$

此时, ρ^{∞} 是由初值条件和边界条件确定的常数. 当 $\lambda(\varepsilon) = \lambda_0 \varepsilon^2$ 时, 有 $\theta \approx 0$,

$$f(t,x,v) \xrightarrow{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} f^{\lambda_0}(t,x,v) = \rho^{\lambda_0}(t,x) E(v), \quad (17)$$

其中, ρ^{λ_0} 满足抛物方程

$$\frac{\partial \rho^{\lambda_0}}{\partial t}(t, x) = \frac{\lambda_0}{\sigma} \Theta \frac{\partial^2 \rho^{\lambda_0}}{\partial x^2}(t, x). \quad (18)$$

再令 $t \rightarrow +\infty$ 或 $\lambda_0 \rightarrow +\infty$, 可得 $\rho^{\lambda_0}(t, x) \rightarrow \rho^\infty(x)$. 对于更复杂的碰撞算子, 一种可行的策略是采用线性加罚对模型进行重构. 以各向异性散射为例, 其碰撞算子可写为

$$C(f) = \int_{\mathbb{V}} \sigma(v, v')(f(t, x, v') - f(t, x, v)) dv', \quad \int_{\mathbb{V}} \sigma(v, v') dv' = 1. \quad (19)$$

可将其分解为

$$C(f) = P(f) + Q(f), \quad P(f) = C(f) - Q(f), \quad (20)$$

其中, $P(f) = \sigma_0(f_{eq}(t, x, v) - f(t, x, v))$ 为罚项, $Q(f)$ 为源项. 应用前文所述的模型重构过程, 便能构造出渐近保持的宏观-微观输运模型.

1.2 数值格式

下面我们以一阶有限体积格式为例描述数值格式的构造过程. 设 τ_n 为第 n 个时间步的步长, $\tau = \max_n \tau_n$, x_i 是单元 $I_i = [x_{i-1/2}, x_{i+1/2}]$ 的中点, $h_i = x_{i+1/2} - x_{i-1/2}$, $h = \max_i h_i$, (v_k, w_k) 是第 k 个离散速度点与其对应的积分权重, ρ_i^n 是变量 ρ 在 t_n 时刻单元 I_i 上的均值, $f_{i,k}^n$ 是变量 f 在 t_n 时刻单元 I_i 上第 k 个离散速度分量的均值, $T_k^n x = x - \frac{v_k}{\varepsilon} \tau_n$ 是位置点 x 沿第 k 个离散速度回溯至 t_n 时刻的上游位置点. 数值格式的构造分为两个步骤: [宏观方程的离散和微观方程的离散. 整体算法流程可见图 1.](#)

1) 宏观方程的离散. 时间上采用向后欧拉时间离散, 可得:

$$\frac{\rho_i^{n+1/2} - \rho_i^n}{\tau_n} + \frac{1}{\varepsilon} e^{-\sigma \tau_n / \lambda} \sum_k w_k v_k S_{h,k}^n (f_{\perp,i,k}^n + \theta f_{eq,i,k}^n) = \frac{\lambda}{\varepsilon^2 \sigma} (1 - \theta) (1 - e^{-\sigma \tau_n / \lambda}) \Theta D_h \rho_i^{n+1/2}. \quad (21)$$

这里可以看到, 我们对扩散项 $D_h \rho$ 采用隐式时间离散, 因而在抛物极限处能够克服抛物型时间步长约束 $\tau \sim h^2$. 在宏观数值格式的构造过程中, 离散输运算子 $S_{h,k}^n$ 的构造是关键, 下面我们介绍两种典型思想:

a) 短程回溯. 该思想源自统一气体动力学格式^[39,43], 通过沿局部特征线回溯重构界面通量. 记 $g = f_{\perp} + \theta f_{eq}$, 定义

$$S_{h,k}^n g_{i,k}^n = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{h_i} (g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,l} - g_{i-1/2,k}^{n,l}), & v_k > 0; \\ \frac{1}{h_i} (g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,r} - g_{i-1/2,k}^{n,r}), & v_k < 0. \end{cases} \quad (22)$$

其中, $g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,l}$ 是通量左侧重构值, $g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,r}$ 是通量右侧重构值. 对于一阶格式而言, 可取 $g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,l} = g_{i,k}^n$ 和 $g_{i+1/2,k}^{n,r} = g_{i+1,k}^n$. 由于短程回溯时的特征线截断造成数值依赖域缩小, 导致该方法在过渡区域的稳定性条件为 $\tau \sim \varepsilon h$.

b) 长程回溯^[44,45]. 该思想源自半拉格朗日 (Semi-Lagrangian) 格式^[49,50], 通过严格追踪特征线至上游时间层, 利用上游单元重构追踪点处的信息. 因为数值依赖域严格包含微分方程依赖域, 所以该方法的稳定性不受时间步长约束. 假设 $T_k^n x \in I_m$, $g_{*,k}^n(x)$ 是基于 $\{g_{i,k}^n\}$ 信息的重构多项式, 满足对于所有 $\ell \in \{0,1\}$,

$$\begin{cases} \frac{1}{h_{m-\ell}} \int_{I_{m-\ell}} g_{*,k}^n(x) dx = g_{m-\ell,k}^n, & v_k > 0; \\ \frac{1}{h_{m+\ell}} \int_{I_{m+\ell}} g_{*,k}^n(x) dx = g_{m+\ell,k}^n, & v_k < 0. \end{cases} \quad (23)$$

由此可定义如下离散输运算符:

$$S_{h,k}^n g_{i,k}^n = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{h_i} (g_{*,k}^n(T_k^n(x_{i+1/2}^-)) - g_{*,k}^n(T_k^n(x_{i-1/2}^-))), & v_k > 0; \\ \frac{1}{h_i} (g_{*,k}^n(T_k^n(x_{i+1/2}^+)) - g_{*,k}^n(T_k^n(x_{i-1/2}^+))), & v_k < 0. \end{cases} \quad (24)$$

2) 微观方程的离散. 对于无条件稳定的微观数值格式的构造过程, 我们介绍两种研究思路:

a) 全隐格式. 时间上采用向后欧拉时间离散, 可得:

$$\frac{f_{i,k}^{n+1} - f_{i,k}^n}{\tau_n} + \frac{v_k}{\varepsilon} B_{h,k} f_{i,k}^{n+1} = \frac{\sigma}{\lambda} (f_{eq,i,k}^{n+1} - f_{i,k}^{n+1}). \quad (25)$$

其中, $B_{h,k}$ 是迎风离散算子, 其一阶形式如下:

$$B_{h,k} f_{i,k}^n = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{h_i} (f_{i,k}^n - f_{i-1,k}^n), & v_k > 0; \\ \frac{1}{h_i} (f_{i+1,k}^n - f_{i,k}^n), & v_k < 0. \end{cases} \quad (26)$$

对于输运方程离散后得到的线性代数系统, 常采用源迭代(source iteration)方法求解. 该方法的核心思想是预估 f_{eq}^{n+1} , 解耦各离散速度点对应的离散方程, 从而实现逐速度的并行求解. 为保证迭代法的收敛性, 为确保源迭代的收敛性,

需要构造合适的预条件子, 最典型的策略是合成加速型方法^[51-54](synthetic acceleration). 为进一步提高迭代效率, 一方面可利用历史信息构造更优的搜索方向, 例如 Krylov 子空间方法^[55,56]; 另一方面也可借助多重网格方法^[57,58]在不同网格层次间传递误差以加速收敛. 此外, 若能获得高质量的初始迭代解, 也可显著减少迭代次数. 在我们的算法框架中, 宏观方程提供了高质量的数值局部平衡态 $f_{eq}^{n+1/2}$, 可视为特殊的初始迭代解, 仅需单步更新即可将残差降至目标精度. 关于输运方程迭代法的系统介绍, 可参考综述文章^[59].

b) 半拉格朗日格式. 时间上采用向后欧拉格式,

$$f_{i,k}^{n+1} = \frac{\lambda}{\lambda + \sigma \tau_n} S_{i,k}^n f_{i,k}^n + \frac{\sigma \tau_n}{\lambda + \sigma \tau_n} f_{eq,i,k}^{n+1}. \quad (27)$$

记 $f_{*,k}^n(x)$ 是基于 $\{f_{i,k}^n\}$ 信息的重构多项式, 由此可定义离散输运算子:

$$S_{h,k}^n f_{i,k}^n = f_{*,k}^n(T_k^n(x_i)). \quad (28)$$

当 f_{eq}^{n+1} 给定时, 微观量的更新无需求解线性方程组, 且 t_{n+1} 时刻各空间单元之间不存在依赖关系, 从而能够实现逐单元、逐速度的完全并行求解, 特别适合在大规模并行集群上执行^[60,61]. 若令 $f_{eq}^{n+1} = f_{eq}^{n+1/2}$, 仅需单步更新即可得到目标精度的微观数值解. 关于高精度半拉格朗日格式的构造, 可参考文献^[62-64].

c) 蒙特卡罗格式. 假定数值解有如下表示:

$$f(t, x, v) = \sum_p \omega_p(t) \delta(x - x_p(t)) \delta(v - v_p(t)), \quad (29)$$

其中, $x_p(t)$, $v_p(t)$ 和 $\omega_p(t)$ 分别是粒子 p 在 t 时刻的位置, 速度和权重, 它们满足以下关系:

$$\frac{dx_p}{dt} = \frac{v_p}{\varepsilon}, \quad \frac{dv_p}{dt} = 0, \quad \frac{d\omega_p}{dt} = -\frac{\sigma}{\lambda} \omega_p. \quad (30)$$

粒子的初始位置, 速度和时间通过随机抽样确定, 而其初始权重则依据给定的初值条件、边值条件及预估值 f_{eq}^{n+1} 进行分配. 与需要根据指数分布解析处理粒子散射的传统蒙特卡罗方法相比, 本方法无需显式模拟每次散射, 而是将散射项拆分为阻尼项和源项. 这一改进在方差略有增加的情况下, 显著改善了计算效率, 达成了良好的性能权衡.

需要指出的是, 对于宏观方程(21)中的对流项计算, 我们可采用蒙特卡罗方法进行求解. 记 $g = f_{\perp} + \theta f_{eq}$, 可定义离散输运算子如下:

$$\bar{S}_h^n g_i^n = \frac{1}{\tau_n h_i} \left(\sum_{p \in A_{i+1/2}^n} \text{sign}(v_p) \omega_p - \sum_{p \in A_{i-1/2}^n} \text{sign}(v_p) \omega_p \right), \quad (31)$$

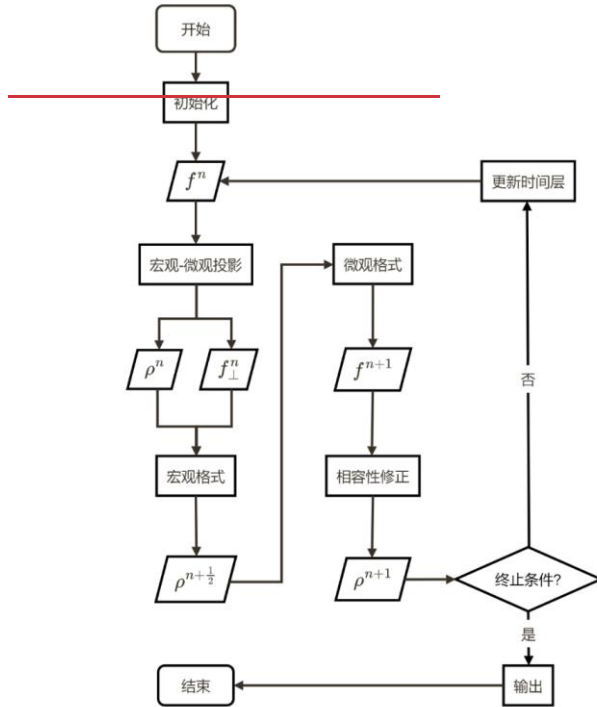
其中, $A_{i+1/2}^n$ 表示在时间区间 $[t_n, t_{n+1}]$ 内穿过 $x_{i+1/2}$ 的所有粒子, 包括来自上一层的源粒子, 边界条件粒子以及由 f_{eq} 在 t_n 时刻放出的粒子. 从而, 宏观离散格式可改写为:

$$\frac{\rho_i^{n+1/2} - \rho_i^n}{\tau_n} + \frac{1}{\varepsilon} \bar{S}_h^n g_i^n = \frac{\lambda}{\varepsilon^2 \sigma} (1 - \theta) (1 - e^{-\sigma \tau_n / \lambda}) \Theta D_h \rho_i^{n+1/2}. \quad (32)$$

关于蒙特卡罗方法的实现细节, 可参考文献[65,66].

3) 宏观-微观相容性. 若直接令 $\rho^{n+1} = \rho^{n+1/2}$, 将会造成数值模拟的不稳定, 其根源在于宏观量与微观量之间缺乏相容性, 即, $\rho^{n+1/2} \neq \sum_k w_k f_k^{n+1}$. 为此, 我们需要利用微观量对宏观量进行相容重构:

$$\rho_i^{n+1} = \sum_k w_k f_{i,k}^{n+1}. \quad (33)$$



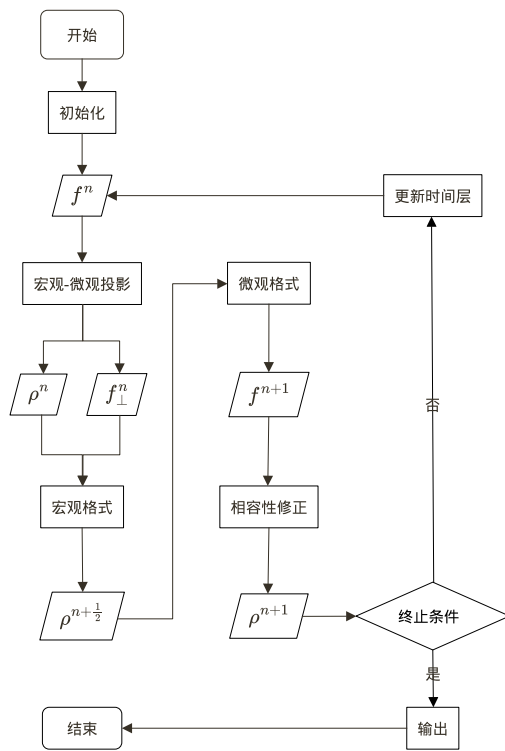


图 1 算法流程图.

Fig. 1 Algorithm flowchart.

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2 在辐射输运问题中的应用

2.1 线性输运方程

下面我们给出线性输运方程的部分三维数值算例. 间断有限元方法是求解双曲型微分方程的一类高精度数值方法, 其在并行计算、处理复杂几何和自适应网格细化(hp-adaptivity)等方面具有天然优势. 近年来, 针对动理学方程的渐近保持半拉格朗日格式得到广泛研究, 详见相关文献[67–70]等, 和本文不同的是其考虑的极限不包含对流速度的刚性; 关于半拉格朗日间断有限元格式的具体构造, 可参考文献[71–73]. 记具有 p 阶时间精度和 q 阶空间精度的半拉格朗日间断有限元方法为 $SLpLDGq$ [45], 并对比基于交错网格的二阶显式球谐函数法 StaRMAP [74]. 本节展示的数值结果均来源于文献[45].

1) 三维变散射系数问题. 由图 2 所示, 对于具有剧烈空间变化的散射系数分布, 特征线方法利用沿特征方向追踪信息的机制, 在大时间步长约束的条件下仍能保持稳定可靠的计算结果; 相比之下, 传统显式格式在相同时间步长条件下

呈现数值不稳定性, 难以得到有效的数值结果. [

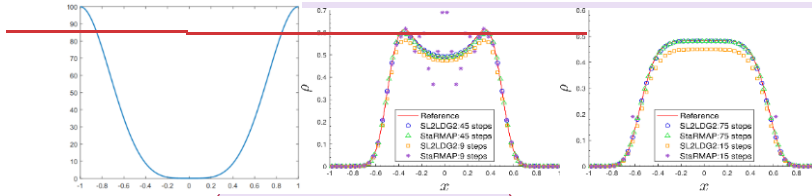


图2 三维变散射问题. 左: 散射系数分布图. 中, 右: 特征线法与球谐函数法的对比图.
Fig. 2 Three-dimensional varying scattering problem. Left: Scattering distribution. Middle, Right: Comparison of characteristic and spherical harmonic solutions.

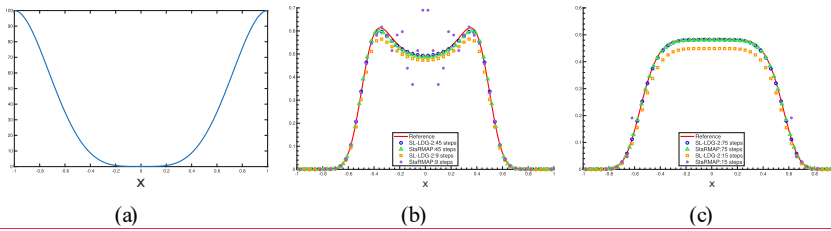


图2 三维变散射问题. (a) 散射系数分布图; (b)(c)特征线法与球谐函数法的对比图.
Fig. 2 Three-dimensional varying scattering problem. (a) Scattering distribution; (b)(c) Comparison of characteristic and spherical harmonic solutions.

2) 三维点源问题. 由图 3 所示, 当分布函数剧烈变化时, 球谐函数法虽然能够保持解的旋转不变性, 但是容易产生非物理数值振荡; 而离散速度法由于严格保持输运结构, 不容易产生波动. 由表 1 可见, 本文所提方法的并行效率高, 其加速比随计算核心数增加依然接近线性增长, 验证了前文的理论分析结果.

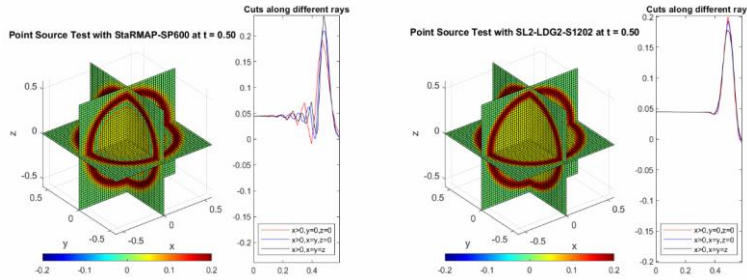


图3 三维点源问题($\sigma=1$). 左: 球谐函数法; 右: 离散速度法.
Fig. 3 Three-dimensional point-source problem ($\sigma=1$). Left: spherical harmonic method; Right: discrete velocity method.

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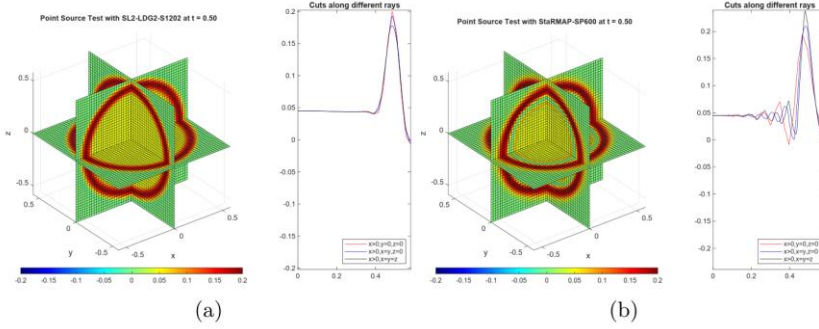


图 3 三维点源问题($\sigma = 1$). (a) 球谐函数法; (b)离散速度法.

Fig. 3 Three-dimensional point source problem ($\sigma = 1$). (a) Spherical harmonic method; (b) Discrete velocity method.

表 1 三维点源问题的 OpenMP 并行效率测试.

Table 1 Parallel efficiency test for the three-dimensional point source problem with OpenMP.

线程数	运行时间(秒)	加速比	并行效率
1	13552.66	-	-
2	6835.17	1.98	99.14%
4	3512.93	3.86	96.45%
8	1641.28	8.26	103.22%
16	1047.95	12.93	80.83%

2.2 非线性辐射输运方程

对于非线性辐射输运方程, 基于粒子的蒙特卡罗方法是主流的数值模拟工具之一. 在源项的离散上, 显式蒙特卡罗方法受到极为严格的时间步长限制. 目前, 隐式蒙特卡罗(IMC, Implicit Monte Carlo)^[66]是应用最为广泛的算法. 该方法将光子的吸收与再发射过程近似为“伪散射”, 虽显著增强了计算的稳定性, 但在光学厚介质区域会引入高昂的计算开销. 为提高计算效率并规避伪散射的引入, 我们将基于特征线近似的宏观模型与传统蒙特卡罗方法相结合, 构造了新型蒙特卡罗方法^[46,47](EMC), 并对比具有相同参数的 IMC 方法.

1) Infinite medium 问题(方差测试). 本算例求解的是灰体辐射输运方程, 数值结果来源于文献[47]. 我们模拟一个处于扩散尺度的无限平板问题, 真实解应该保持恒定温度. 定义方差与计算时间的性能指标(FOM, Figure of Merit)为

$$FOM = \frac{1}{VAR \times RT},$$

其中, VAR 是方差, RT 是 CPU 运行时间. 更高的 FOM 代表着更好的综合计算

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性能. 当模拟时间 $t=1.0\text{ ns}$ 时, 如表 2 所示, IMC 方法耗时 669 秒, EMC 方法仅耗时 53 秒. 由图 4 所示, 虽然 EMC 方法的温度变化相较 IMC 方法更加剧烈, 但是其 FOM 指标仍表现出明显优势, 这表明 EMC 以略高的方差代价换取了计算效率的提升. 在光学厚区域中, IMC 方法引入的伪散射机制会显著延长粒子的有效存活时间, 使辐射能量缓慢沉积到物质场中, 因而温度更新时的统计波动较小. 相较而言, EMC 方法基于宏观方程对发射源项进行估计并直接抽样, 大量的粒子权重快速衰减至 0, 意味着辐射能量更加迅速地沉积到物质场中, 从而使温度更新更容易表现出更大的瞬时波动.

表 2 Infinite medium 问题 CPU 运行时间对比.
Table 2 CPU runtime comparison of Infinite medium problem.

算例	EMC(秒)	IMC(秒)
Infinite medium	53	669

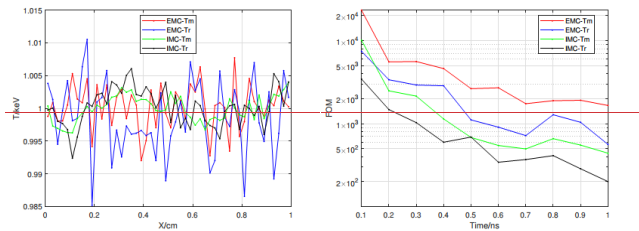


图 4 Infinite medium 问题. 左: 温度对比. 右: FOM 指标对比.
Fig. 4 Infinite medium problem. Left: comparison of temperature. Right: comparison of FOM.

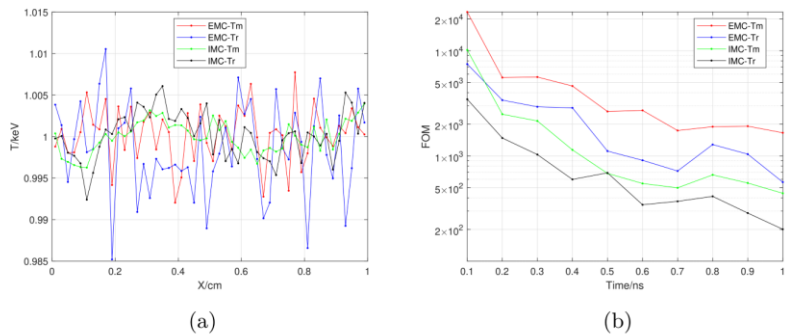


图 4 Infinite medium 问题. (a) 温度对比; (b) FOM 指标对比.
Fig. 4 Infinite medium problem. (a) Comparison of temperature. (b) Comparison of FOM.

2) Marshark-2B 问题. 本算例求解的是灰体辐射输运方程, 数值结果来源于

文献[46]. 由表 3 和图 5 可知, 对于扩散占优的问题, 在参数相同的情况下, EMC 与 IMC 的数值解高度吻合. 尽管 EMC 方法的方差稍大, 但其计算效率具有显著优势.

表 3 Marshark-2B 问题 CPU 运行时间对比.

Table 3 CPU runtime comparison of Mashark-2B problem.

算例	EMC(秒)	IMC(秒)
Marshark-2B	1578	14694

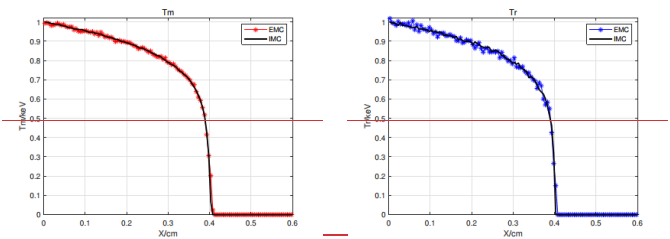


图 5 Marshark-2B 问题. 左: 物质温度. 右: 辐射温度.

Fig. 5 Marshark 2B problem. Left: material temperature. Right: radiation temperature.

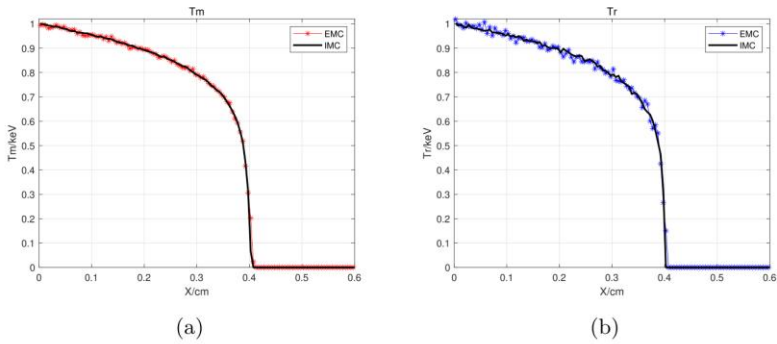


图 5 Marshark-2B 问题. (a) 物质温度; (b) 辐射温度.

Fig. 5 Marshark-2B problem. (a) Material temperature; (b) Radiation temperature.

3)多群空腔问题. 本算例求解的是频率依赖辐射输运方程, 数值结果来源于文献[47]. 由表 4 和图 6 可知, 对于阻尼系数间断的问题, EMC 与 IMC 在相同参数下的数值解同样高度吻合. 虽然 EMC 的统计波动较大, 但其计算速度显著提升.

表 4 多群空腔问题 CPU 运行时间对比.

Table 4 CPU runtime comparison of the multi-group hohlraum problem.

算例	EMC(秒)	IMC(秒)
Hohlraum	17687	96332

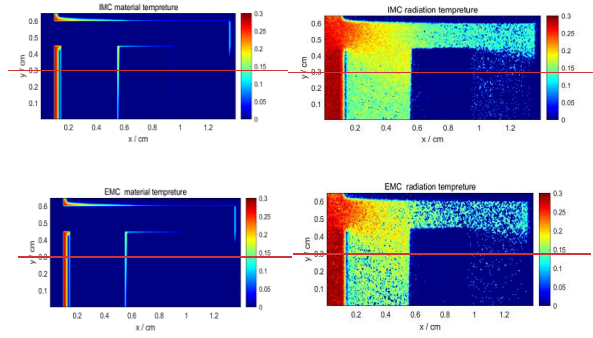


图6 多群空腔问题. 左上: IMC 物质温度. 右上: IMC 辐射温度. 左下: EMC 物质温度. 右下: EMC 辐射温度.

Fig. 6 Multi-group hohlraum problem. Left upper: IMC material temperature. Right upper: IMC radiation temperature. Left lower: EMC material temperature. Right lower: EMC radiation temperature.

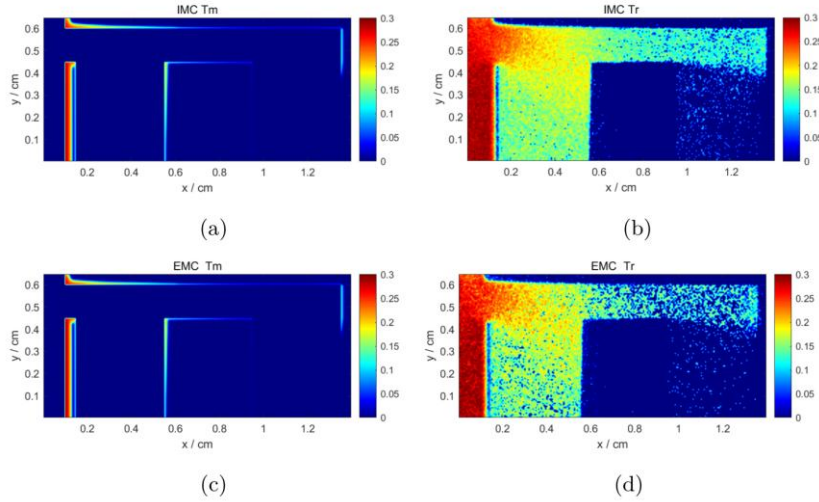


图6 多群空腔问题. (a) IMC 物质温度; (b) IMC 辐射温度; (c) EMC 物质温度; (d) EMC 辐射温度.

Fig. 6 Multi-group hohlraum problem. (a) IMC material temperature; (b) IMC radiation temperature; (c) EMC material temperature; (d) EMC radiation temperature.

3 结论

本文介绍了一类基于特征线回溯思想构造的渐近保持格式, 并展示其在辐射运输问题中的应用. 该方法的核心理念是沿特征线构建尺度自适应的宏观-微

观耦合模型,以还原理学模型的渐近极限.在数值计算过程中,先求解宏观方程以获得宏观量的预测值,再求解微观方程并对宏观量进行相容修正,形成闭合的迭代框架.该方法具备全尺度一致的无条件稳定性,优异的并行效率和良好的扩展性,适合求解高维跨尺度动力学问题.

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Efficient Asymptotic-Preserving Method Based on Characteristics for Kinetic Equations

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Abstract: Kinetic equations serve as fundamental mathematical models for describing the dynamic behavior of particle systems. Their intrinsic multiscale structure, however, poses significant challenges in developing efficient and robust numerical schemes. A popular approach is to design asymptotic preserving (AP) schemes. It aims to create a unified solver across the computational domain that captures the correct asymptotic limits at a discrete level. In recent years, we have developed a class of unconditionally stable AP schemes based on characteristic backtracking. These methods feature low computational complexity, high parallel efficiency, and excellent scalability, making them particularly suitable for long-time simulations of high-dimensional, multiscale transport phenomena. Owing to these advantages, the proposed framework holds great potential for applications in national defense engineering, astrophysics, semiconductor, and biochemistry.

Keywords: kinetic equation; parallel computing; characteristic backtracking; asymptotic preserving